the relevant policies using TPE (typed partial evaluation). Instead of returning a simple `allow` or `deny` decision, Cedar TPE produces a policy residual that shows the remaining constraints under which access would be allowed.

The policy residual is then passed to a component that converts it into a query filter that represents concrete constraints that can be applied during retrieval. Each chunk in the vector database is stored with metadata that captures relevant attributes, such as tenant, ownership, or classification. The query filter is applied to this metadata when retrieving results, ensuring that only chunks within the authorized scope are considered. For example, in a multi-tenant system, the filter might restrict retrieval to chunks associated with a specific tenant.

The retrieved results constitute authorized additional context. This context flows into a prompt constructor, where it is combined with the user's instruction to form the final prompt sent to the LLM. Because retrieval itself is constrained by policy, the language model never sees unauthorized data. Its role is limited to generating output based on inputs that have already been vetted by authorization.